

Across Borders: A Missing Voice

跨越边界：缺席的声音

Theme: 旅行、交通与文化交流 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The missing voice belonged to a woman who ran a **tiny motel** on the **corridor** between the station and the port. Her **livelihood** was the **queue**: a **taxi**, a **tram**, a **trolley**, and a **cart** all stopped at her door. “A vehicle is not a **conveyance**,” she said. “It is a promise that someone will come back.” Her face, when she said it, was entirely **sincere**, and she had been saying it for a year.

The committee had never asked her anything. **According to** the plan, the new line would **shut** the **corridor** at night and serve only the far end of the district, leaving her one open hour. “We hereby revise nothing,” the **introductory** letter said, **electronically** and without **sincerity**. A **recreational bicycle**, a **soccer** ball, and a **postcard** from the **kingdom** of the north were the only things in her window. We had no **automobile** and no **auto** of any kind, and the **fireplace** in the waiting room had not been lit for a year.

A **psychologist** from the exchange campus came with an **exhaustive** report: the **sore** shoulder of a passenger, the **lazy** habit of a distributor, and the **inch** of platform that made a wheelchair impossible. “A **boat** and an **aircraft** are both rooms,” she said. “The difference is where you keep the **ax**.” A volunteer would **accompany** her on the walk through the depot, and the depot was where the report had to be handed over.

They were **slightly** late for the meeting, and the **mortgage** on the depot was due the same week. “We cannot **mechanize** a promise,” Maya said. “We can only **mechanize** a gate.” A **ballet** company travelled through with their costumes, a **tram** driver with forty years of service, and a **taxi** owner with a **sore** hand: all of them had signed the same petition, and all of them were available to speak.

The **instructive** part was the **queue** itself. Together they measured it: so many seconds per person, so many **horsepower** per hour, and **thereby** a number that the committee could not ignore. “You must create one open position for the night run,” Aisha said, “including the stop that serves nobody but her.” And they bought the **postcard**, and put it in the report. Near the **pond**, a distributor of tickets would **acquaint** every new passenger with the rules, and the **distributive** effect of the new timetable was obvious in her ledger.

中文翻译

那个缺席的声音属于一位在车站与港口之间那条走廊上经营小汽车旅馆的女士。她的生计就是那条队伍：出租车、电车、手推车和马车都会停在她的门口。“车辆不是运输，”她说，“它是一个有人会回来的承诺。”她说这话时的表情完全真挚，而她已经说了一年。

委员会从来没有问过她任何事。按照计划，新线路将在夜里关闭这条走廊，只服务这个区最远的一端，只给她留一个开放的小时。“我们据此不作任何修订，”那封介绍性的信写道，以电子方式，而且毫无诚意。她橱窗里只有一辆休闲自行车、一个足球，以及一张来自北方王国明信片。我们没有任何汽车，候车室的壁炉也已经一年没有点过。

交换校园的一位心理学家带来了一份详尽的报告：一位乘客酸痛의肩、一位分销商懒惰的习惯，以及那一英寸让轮椅无法通行的站台。“船和飞机都是房间，”她说，“区别在于你把斧头放在哪里。”一名志愿者会陪她走过车辆段，而那份报告必须在车辆段递交。

他们开会稍微迟到了，而车辆段的抵押贷款就在同一周到期。“我们无法把承诺机械化，”曼雅说，“我们只能把一道闸门机械化。”一个芭蕾舞团带着服装经过，一位有四十年工龄的电车司机，以及一位手疼的出租车车主：他们都签了同一份请愿书，而且他们都可以出面作证。

有教益的部分就是那条队伍本身。他们一起丈量了它：每人多少秒、每小时多少马力，并由此得出一个委员会无法忽视的数字。“你们必须为夜间班次设一个开放的位置，”艾莎说，“包括那个只服务她一个人的站。”于是他们买下了那张明信片，把它放进了报告。池塘附近，一位售票的分发者会让每一位新乘客熟悉规则；而新时刻表在分配上的效果，在她的账本里一目了然。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
slightly 'slaitli POS: adv	adv. 些微地, 苗条地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. to a small degree or extent
boat bəʊt POS: n	n. 船; vi. 乘船; vt. 以船运 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small vessel for travel on water; v. ride in a boat on water
tiny 'taini POS: a	a. 很少的, 微小的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s very small
aircraft 'eəkræft POS: n	n. 航空器, 飞机; [机] 航空器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a vehicle that can fly
shut ʃʌt POS: n	n. 关闭; vt. 关上, 闭起, 幽禁, 合拢, 轧住; vi. 关上, 停止营业 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not open
accompany ə'kʌmpəni POS: vt	vt. 陪伴, 伴随, 补充, 为...伴奏; vi. 伴奏, 伴唱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. go or travel along with
kingdom 'kɪŋdəm POS: n	n. 王国, 领域; [医] 界(动物, 植物, 矿物) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a domain in which something is dominant; n. a country with a king as head of state; n. the domain ruled by a...
inch ɪnʃ POS: n	n. 英寸, 身高, 小岛; vi. 慢慢前进, 慢慢移动; vt. 使缓慢地移动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a unit of length equal to one twelfth of a foot
mortgage 'mɔ:ɡɪdʒ POS: n	n. 抵押, 约束性义务, 抵押借款; vt. 抵押, 以...作担保, 把...许给 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a conditional conveyance of property as security for the repayment of a loan; v. put up as security or coll...
corridor 'kɒrɪdə POS: n	n. 走廊, 回廊, 人口密集地带 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an enclosed passageway; rooms usually open onto it
thereby 'ðeəbaɪ POS: adv	adv. 因此 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. by that means or because of that
psychologist saɪ'kɒlədʒɪst POS: n	n. 心理学家; [医] 心理学家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a scientist trained in psychology
auto 'ɔ:təu POS: n	n. 汽车; pref. 表示"自己"、"本身", 表示"自己的", 表示"自动的" Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a motor vehicle with four wheels; usually propelled by an internal combustion engine
taxi 'tæksi POS: n	n. 出租车; vi. 乘出租车; vt. 用出租车送 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. travel slowly; v. ride in a taxicab
pond pɒnd POS: n	n. 池塘; v. 筑成池塘 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small lake
soccer 'spɒkə POS: n	n. 英式足球 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a football game in which two teams of 11 players try to kick or head a ball into the opponents' goal
automobile 'ɔ:təməbi:l POS: n	n. 汽车; [机] 汽车 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. travel in an automobile
cart kɑ:t POS: n	n. 二轮运货马车; vi. 驾运货马车; vt. 用车装载 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a heavy open wagon usually having two wheels and drawn by an animal; v. transport something in a cart
bicycle 'baɪsɪkl POS: n	n. 自行车 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a wheeled vehicle that has two wheels and is moved by foot pedals; v. ride a bicycle
ballet 'bæleɪ POS: n	n. 芭蕾舞 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a theatrical representation of a story that is performed to music by trained dancers; n. music written for...
revise rɪ'vaɪz POS: n	n. 校订, 修正, 改样; vt. 校订, 修正, 校正 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make revisions in
queue kju: POS: n	n. 辫子, 一队人, 队列; vt. 使排队, 将...梳成辫子; vi. 排队; [计] 队列 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a line of people or vehicles waiting for something; n. (information processing) an ordered list of tasks to...
motel məu'tel POS: n	n. 汽车旅馆 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a motor hotel

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
fireplace 'faɪəpleɪs POS: n	n. 壁炉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an open recess in a wall at the base of a chimney where a fire can be built
recreational ,rekri'eɪʃənəl POS: a	a. 消遣的, 娱乐的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to recreation
postcard 'pəʊstkɑ:d POS: n	n. 明信片 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a card for sending messages by post without an envelope
trolley 'trɒli POS: n	n. 电车, 手推车, 台车; vt. 用手推车运; vi. 乘电车 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a wheeled vehicle that runs on rails and is propelled by electricity
lazy 'leɪzi POS: a	a. 懒惰的, 怠惰的, 缓慢的; vi. 懒散 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. moving slowly and gently
sore sɔː POS: a	a. 悲伤的, 痛的, 引起痛苦的; n. 痛处, 溃疡, 疮 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an open skin infection
tram træm POS: n	n. 电车轨道, 煤车, 纬纱, 纬丝; vt. 用煤车运载; vi. 乘电车 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. travel by tram
sincere sɪn'sɪə POS: a	a. 诚实的, 正直的, 真挚的, 纯净的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. open and genuine; not deceitful
introductory ,ɪntrə'dʌktəri POS: a	a. 介绍的, 引导的, 开头的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. serving to open or begin; s. serving as an introduction or preface
livelihood 'laɪvlihud POS: n	n. 生计, 营生, 生活 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the financial means whereby one lives
acquaint ə'kweɪnt POS: vt	vt. 使认识, 介绍 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. inform
electronically phonetic unavailable POS: adv	adv. 电子地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. by electronic means
sincerity sɪn'serəti POS: n	n. 诚实, 真实, 诚心诚意 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being open and truthful; not deceitful or hypocritical; n. a quality of naturalness and simp...
ax æks POS: n	n. 斧头; vt. 用斧削或砍, 削减 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an edge tool with a heavy bladed head mounted across a handle; v. terminate
exhaustive ɪg'zɔːstɪv POS: a	a. 消耗的, 枯竭的, 彻底的, 详尽的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. performed comprehensively and completely
instructive ɪn'strʌktɪv POS: a	a. 有益的, 增进知识的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. serving to instruct or enlighten or inform
horsepower 'hɔːspaʊə POS: n	n. 马力; [电] 马力 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a unit of power equal to 746 watts
hereby hɪə'baɪ POS: adv	adv. 因此, 据此 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. (formal) by means of this
conveyance kən'veɪəns POS: n	n. 运输, 运输工具, 财产转让; [经] 运输工具, 转让证书, 财产的转让 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. document effecting a property transfer; n. the transmission of information; n. something that serves as a me...
distributive dɪ'strɪbjʊtɪv POS: a	a. 分发的, 分配的, 分布的; n. 分配词 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. serving to distribute or allot or disperse
mechanize 'mekənaɪz POS: vt	vt. 使机械化, 用机械装置, 机动化; [机] 机械化之, 令其机械化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. equip with armed and armored motor vehicles; v. make monotonous; make automatic or routine; v. make mechanic...
according to phonetic unavailable POS: review required	根据, 按照; 取决于; 据...所说 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: No reliable source example available.